



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Lighthouse Christian Academy

School Website: <https://lcacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Lighthouse Christian Academy (MD 21666) presents a robust Classical Christian profile. Public materials consistently foreground classical methods, liberal-arts orientation, and integration of Scripture, with explicit emphasis on formation of character, virtue, wisdom, and a Biblical worldview. The school highlights aims such as truth, goodness, and beauty; Great Conversation; Latin, logic, rhetoric, and Great Books; and a pedagogy that blends contemplative memory work (e.g., singing, memorization) with Socratic inquiry and debate in the upper grades. The community emphasizes partnership with parents, a family-centered culture, and a campus anchored in Christ and local sponsoring churches. Overall, the school demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across most categories, with one category showing only partial/Somewhat Classical alignment due to explicit articulation gaps around certain faculty-formation language. See category-by-category synthesis below for details and evidence.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence: Public materials repeatedly frame education through a Christian, Biblical worldview and a classical lens. The mission emphasizes "cultivates students who embrace traditional wisdom and virtue through a robust classical Christian education ... for Christ," and daily devotions and Scripture-centric framing appear in program descriptions. The "What is Classical?" content explicitly ties formation in faith to the aims of truth, goodness, and beauty.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; Biblical worldview; Jesus; devotions; theology language; Great Conversation; liturgical/communal aspects implied by worship/devotions. Negative indicators such as relativism or secular humanism are not evidenced in the public materials. Estimated positive keyword hits far exceed negative. (Positive: multiple terms; Negative: none detected in public content.)
- Why this rating: The school's language and programmatic emphases align strongly with transcendental moral realism, theology-based grounding, and liturgical/community rhythm, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence: The school proclaims formation of virtue and wisdom as the telos, not merely job preparation; language emphasizes human flourishing, virtue, and the True-Good-Beautiful frame. The Portrait of a Graduate ties wisdom and virtue to habit formation and to Truth-Goodness-Beauty. There is explicit emphasis on Great Conversation and classical formation rather than "21st-century skills" style workforce emphasis.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, Great Conversation, classical heritage. Negative signals (e.g., job-prep jargon) are not present; the content leans away from purely utilitarian framing. Estimated positive keyword hits dominate.
- Why this rating: The philosophy centers on formation and the pursuit of true, good, beautiful, with classical aims and a clearly stated telos beyond mere employment metrics.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Curriculum descriptions explicitly reference the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/primary sources, Latin instruction, classical languages, history across disciplines, and a standard of virtue-centered content. There are mentions of Great Books and the Great Conversation, Latin starting in 3rd grade, logic/debate in upper grades, and Saxon Math; history taught through classic/historical lenses, not merely as “social studies.”
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin, history (Western civilization), primary sources. Negative indicators (e.g., project-based-only framing, social-studies terminology replacing history) are not evidenced; the public content emphasizes traditional subjects and canonical texts. Estimated positives well outnumber any negatives or neutral signals.
- Why this rating: Strong alignment with the classical curriculum canon (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; history as Western civilization and Biblical history; emphasis on wonder and mastery).

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The site documents a bifurcated pedagogy: lower grades emphasize memory work, singing, recitation, and wonder; upper grades center on Socratic discussion, logic, debate, and rhetoric; there is explicit mention of a progression from memory/chant to dialectic and oratory. The presence of both contemplative/restful learning (“scholé”) and rigorous discourse maps to classic pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Socratic discussion, narration/recitation, chanting, memory work, rhetoric, debate, formal/informal logic, seminars, and capstone-like orations. Negative indicators such as an exclusive focus on experiential or project-based learning without structure are not evidenced; the content shows a structured classical progression rather than a solely constructivist approach. Estimated positive keyword hits dominate.
- Why this rating: Pedagogy follows classical patterns (memory and chant in lower grades; Socratic/seminar/debate in upper grades; rhetoric and public speaking opportunities), matching CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The site includes a formal “Faculty and Staff” section with named teachers and position postings (e.g., Latin Teacher, Art Teacher, First Grade/Lower School roles). This demonstrates a professional, credentialed faculty who model aspects of the school’s mission (discipline, virtue-oriented teaching, Christian worldview). However, explicit language about the faculty as the living curriculum, or a formal “portrait of what a teacher should be” in the sense used by some classical schools, is not overtly stated in the public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “faculty,” “teachers,” “mentors” (implied by roles and responsibilities), and specific subject-area postings that emphasize classical education and Christian worldview. Negative indicators include the absence of explicit phrases like “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or a formal teacher-formation framework in the public text. Based on the available content, there is clear classical orientation, but a lack of explicit canonical phrasing around faculty as the living curriculum yields a Somewhat Classical rating.
- Why this rating: Substantial evidence of qualified faculty aligned with classical aims, but the absence of explicit statements about the faculty as the living curriculum or a formal teacher-formation portrait prevents a full CLASSICAL rating in this category. The content supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The school emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers, parent formation (reading groups, seminars), community involvement, and an open-campus approach with opportunities for family engagement. The “School Life” section stresses collaboration with families, and admissions/visits indicate accessibility for parents. Homeschool supervision is also noted, tying parental education to classical aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups, seminars, family involvement, open campus, parent covenant. No explicit negative signals about parent involvement appear in the public materials. The presence of formal parent-facing materials and events suggests CLASSICAL alignment.
- Why this rating: The school explicitly frames parents as partners in formation and provides pathways for parent education and involvement, consistent with a CLASSICAL orientation in this category.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, Lighthouse Christian Academy MD 21666 is CLASSICAL. The single area of some reservation (Element 5: Faculty) does not offset the strong CLASSICAL alignment across the other five categories, and the aggregate signal remains CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make the faculty dimension explicitly “the living curriculum.” Publish a clear statement, visible on the site, describing how the faculty embody virtue, pedagogy, and classical formation; articulate a formal “portrait of a teacher” and a teacher-formation pathway that mirrors the school’s emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and pedagogy in the classical sense.
- Elevate explicit references to scholé and contemplative rest in a way that connects restfulness with memory work and long obedience in the classical sense, ensuring searchability for terms like scholé, contemplation, wonder, and reverence.
- Strengthen articulation of theological/ liturgical practices. If feasible, provide a concise, public articulation of liturgical/communal rhythms (chapel, prayer, worship) to reinforce liturgical foundations more explicitly in line with the lexicon’s positive signals.
- Expand “Great Books” sequencing and Great Conversation signals with a published scope-and-sequence showing canonical authors and primary sources across grades, reinforcing curriculum alignment with classical standards.
- Continue to publish teacher profiles that explicitly connect staff values, formation, and pedagogy to classical aims, to reduce ambiguity around the “Somewhat Classical” designation for Faculty.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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